

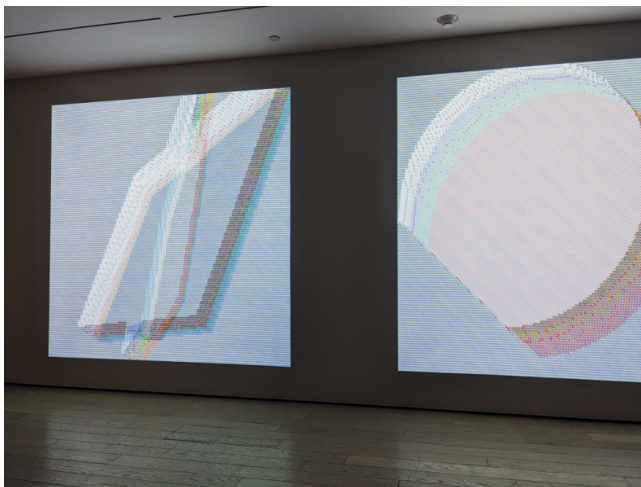
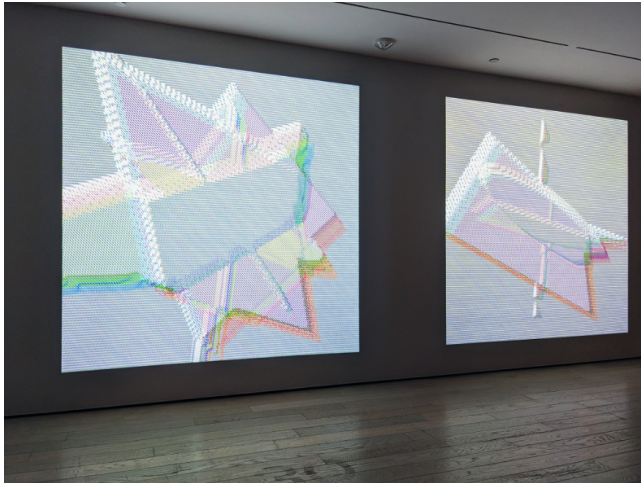
An Empty Room

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1 PROJECT URL

http://reas.com/an_empty_room

2 DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

In conjunction with *Coded: Art Enters the Computer Age, 1952–1982*, LACMA's Art + Technology Lab presents a two-part digital work by Casey Reas: a simulation of and an homage to Victor Vasarely's unrealized proposal for LACMA's Art and Technology Program (1967-71). Vasarely was interested in cybernetics and permutation during this period, and he envisioned a machine composed of lights arranged in a grid that would generate millions of different visual patterns related to his paintings (such as the one on view in *Coded*). Estimated at the time to cost two million dollars to fabricate, the project was deemed prohibitively expensive and was left unrealized.

Reas's response, commissioned by LACMA, is presented in two parts. The first component, *METAVASARELY*, simulates Vasarely's proposed machine; examples of the patterns generated, as well as an interactive version. For the second component, *An Empty Room* (on view here), Reas created software inspired by Vasarely's ideas of a "binary plastic language" as the basis for this series of perpetually generative digital imagery.

3 ARTIST INFORMATION

Casey Reas software, prints, and installations have been featured in numerous solo and group exhibitions at museums and galleries. His work ranges from small works on paper to urban-scale installations, and he balances solo work in the studio with collaborations with architects and musicians. Reas' work is in a range of private and public collections, including the Centre Georges Pompidou and the San Francisco Museum of Modern Art. Reas is a professor at the University of California, Los Angeles. He holds a master's degree from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology in Media Arts and Sciences and a bachelor's degree from the College of Design, Architecture, Art, and Planning at the University of Cincinnati. With Ben Fry, Reas initiated Processing in 2001; Processing is an open-source programming language and environment for the visual arts.

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